James Hong

Applied Research Scientist

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MISSION

(1) Scaling data curation and infrastructure for multi-modal intelligence.
(2) Building the right data visualizations to "look at" billion-scale image data – i.e., statistical sampling and interactivity.
(3) Instilling photographic and cinematic aesthetics in visual generative models.

SKILLS

Computer Vision, NLP, Data Visualization, Cloud Computing (GCP, AWS, Azure), Distributed Systems
Python, PyTorch, Ray, C/C++, Rust, JavaScript, Java, Scala, LaTeX, Linux

EXPERIENCE

Member of Technical Staff — *OpenAI* 2026–Present
Image Generation Research

Research Scientist / Head of Data — *Reve AI* 2024–2026

- Built web-scale datasets from scratch from a corpus of 100B+ images – including focused data for image aesthetics, safety, editing, etc..
- Led data curation, data infrastructure, and LLM post-training for creative applications.
- Core contributions to state-of-the-art image generation models: Reve Preview, 1.0, 1.5, 2.0, and 2.1. See: reve.com

Research Assistant and (Ten Time) Teaching Assistant — *Stanford University* 2015–2024
Selected teaching: CS149 Parallel Computing (Head TA); CS248 Interactive Computer Graphics; CS144 & 244 Computer Networking; CS224D & CS224N NLP with Deep Learning; CS161 Algorithms.

Research Scientist Intern — *Adobe* 2020

Software Engineering Intern — *Rubrik* 2016, 2017

Software Engineering Intern — *LinkedIn* 2015

Software Development Intern — *PlayStation* 2014

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science — *Stanford University* 2017–2024
Fine-grained Image and Video Analysis with Limited Supervision. Advisor: Kayvon Fatahalian.

M.S. in Computer Science — *Stanford University* 2017
GPA: 3.96 Specialization: Theory / Algorithms

B.S. with Honors in Computer Science — *Stanford University* 2012–2016
GPA: 3.99 Specialization: Computer Networks and Systems

PAST PROJECTS

Learning Subject-Aware Cropping by Outpainting Professional Photos **AAAI ’24**
Using generative AI to teach models aesthetic qualities of photo composition.

Learning to Place Objects into Scenes by Hallucinating Scenes around Objects **SyntheticData4ML @ NeurIPS ’23**
Understanding object location priors with synthetic data.

Spotting Temporally Precise, Fine-Grained Events in Video **ECCV ’22**
Finding events in broadcast sports video at single-frame precision.

Video Pose Distillation for Fine-Grained Sports Action Recognition **ICCV ’21**
Weak supervision for sports video understanding.

Analysis of Who and What Appears in 300,000 Hours of US TV News **KDD ’21**
Computer vision for news analysis; interactive results at tvnews.stanford.edu.

Puffer: A Research Platform for Video Streaming **NSDI ’20**
Adaptive video streaming; recipient of the IRTF Applied Networking Research Prize.

AWARDS

Adobe Research Fellowship Finalist	2022
Brown Institute for Media Innovation Grant	2018
President’s Award for Academic Excellence	2013
B.S. conferred with Distinction (top 15%)	2016
Tau Beta Pi	2015